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Anqi Wang

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Areas of Specialization

Philosophy of science, Causation and causal explanation

Areas of Competence

Logic, Metaphysics, Philosophy of biology, Philosophy of AI

Education

University of Leeds
PhD, Philosophy — 2022-present

Nanjing University
M.A., Philosophy
First-Prize Scholarship — 2019-2022

North-East Normal University
B.S., Environmental Science — 2015-2019

Dissertation

Choosing variables for SEM-based causal explanations

- My dissertation investigates variable choice in SEM-based causal explanation and develops perspicuity as a new criterion for explanatory preferability, while reassessing modularity and proportionality within interventionist causation.

Supervisors: Juha Saatsi, Helen Beebee
External examiner: Lina Jansson (Nottingham University)

Presentations

A trilemma of the Woodwardian definition of proportionality — Jan 2026
APA Eastern Division, Baltimore

A trilemma of the Woodwardian definition of proportionality — Nov 2025
HPS Working-in-Progress Workshop, Leeds

Can structural equation models provide perspicuous explanations? Revisiting the Hodgkin-Huxley model — Nov 2025
PSA Around the World 2025, Online

Can structural equation models provide perspicuous explanations? Revisiting the Hodgkin-Huxley model — July 2025

British Society for the Philosophy of Science (BSPS), Glasgow

Can structural equation models provide perspicuous explanations? Revisiting the Hodgkin-Huxley model — June 2025
Young Scholars Workshop on Philosophy of Science, Shanghai

From statistical correlation to causal interpretation: The role of ideal intervention — July 2024
MCMP Summer School, Munich

Contrastive explanation — May 2023
Philosophy PGR Seminar, Leeds

Research in Progress

Perspicuity and parametric representation—a novel criterion for better explanation

Non-functional causal relationships as a challenge for proportionality

Insensitivity makes modularity possible

The limitation of single-equation-based explanations

How to choose the cause from contrastive explanations? — a challenge from trade-off cases

Teaching

Tutorial

- Led two–three ten-student-group tutorials per week for approximately 150 undergraduate students in total;
- Assessed written assignments (1000-1500 words) and provided constructive, individualised feedback.

Introduction to the history of Western philosophy — 2023-2024 / 2024-2025 Fall
Level 1 module

- The module covers philosophers from ancient Greece through to the eighteenth century, as well as their major ideas and contributions. Topics include Plato's World of Forms, Confucius's concept of li (ritual), Descartes' dualism, and modern and contemporary women philosophers and feminist philosophy, etc.

How science works — 2023-2024 / 2024-2025 Spring
Level 1 module

- The module covers theory-laden observation, scientific realism, the problem of induction, the value-free ideal of science, Kuhn and the scientific revolutions, etc.

Philosophy of biology — 2024-2025

Level 2 & 3 module — Spring

- The module covers the metaphysics of pregnancy, scientific models, the evolution of morality, natural selection and the traits of organisms, the ontology of disease, biological natural kind, etc.

Module Design

Evolution of morality

- This module examines how evolutionary processes may explain the origins of morality and what such explanations imply for moral knowledge and justification. It covers kin selection, reciprocal altruism, game theory, and evolutionary debunking arguments. — 2025 Spring
- Independently designed the module and the syllabus, learning objectives, and teaching materials; Designed and produced lecture slides; Delivered lectures; Planned and led the corresponding seminar.

Services

Conference assistant, BSPS 2026 — July 2026

- Coordinated the scheduling and grouping of all contributed talks and symposia;
- Managed email correspondence with conference participants;
- Produced and edited the conference booklet;
- Provided on-site support throughout the conference.

International Philosophy of Science Reading Group — 2021–Present

- Core member and one of the co-organisers of a 27-member international reading group of Mandarin-speaking researchers and students based in the UK, US, Canada, China, and Singapore.
- Participate in weekly online discussions and provide peer feedback on research papers and works in progress, helping members clarify arguments, identify potential weaknesses, and have mock interviews or presentations;
- Support the group's growth and inclusivity by inviting visiting speakers and welcoming new participants.